

EEFS26

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**EMPOWA
ENTREPRENEURS** Your story matters
INVITATION
**FUNDING
SUMMIT
2026**

THURSDAY 28 MAY 2026 | EMPOWAWORX HOUSE, RANDBURG

GET CONNECTED. GET FUNDED.

FOR PARTNERSHIPS CONTACT:

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TIME	ROLE / SESSION	SPEAKER	DESIGNATION	ORGANISATION	TOPIC / DISCUSSION FOCUS
07:30-08:30	Arrival, Registration & Networking Experience	All delegates			Registration · Networking · Exhibition Engagement
08:30-08:45	Exhibition Preview & Deal Desk Walkthrough	Investment & Ecosystem Teams			Exhibition Preview · Investor Networking · Deal Rooms
08:45-09:00	Welcoming Remarks & Housekeeping	MC: Dr Dudu Makhari			Event Flow · Housekeeping · Delegate Experience
09:00-09:05	Official Welcome Address	Mr Simphiwe Masiza	CEO & Founder	Empowaworx	EmpowaWorx Vision · Capital Access Mission · 2026 Summit Purpose
09:05- 09:10	Introductory Address	Thulisa Bianca Sosibo	Executive Lead: Special Programmes	Empowaworx	
09:10-09:20	Strategic Partner Opening Address	Kgalaletso Tlhoale	Executive: Enterprise Development	ABSA	
09:20- 09:35	Legacy Tribute & Recognition	Johnson “JJ” Njeke (Mfundiso Njeke)	Business Leader, Investor & Institutional Governance Leader		
09:30-10:10	Executive Fire Chat	Facilitator: Dr Dudu Makhari			The Full Equity Spectrum: From Seed to Buyout
		Ndumiso Zulu	CEO	Masisizane Fund: Old Mutual	
		Allon Raiz	CEO	Raizcorp	



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10:10- 10:30	Executive Dialogue	Facilitator: Dr Dudu Makhari		Public Investment Corporation	The Future of Capital Allocation: How DFIs & Institutional Investors Are Funding Growth
		Julian Mixon	Acting Fund Principal	Public Investment Corporation	
		Hlengiwe Makhathini	Group CIO	IDF Capital	
10:30- 10:35	Comfort Break				
10:35-11:30	Executive Panel Discussion	Facilitator: Trudy Theledi	Founder	Invest Edge Africa	Venture Vision to Equity Evolution: What VCs & PE Funds Actually Back in 2026
		Thabelo Ratshihule	CEO	Savant Foundry	
		Tyrone Moodley	Principal	HAVAIC	
		Francisco Da Silva	CEO	Sizoba Group	
		Sihle Gumede	Investment Partner and Executive Director	Sanari Capital	
		Dion Mhlaba	Chief Executive Officer and Founder	Energy Venture Capital	
11:30-11:50	Strategic Workshop	Sameer Jooma	Strategy Growth, Innovation & Digital Transformation Executive	Deloitte	AI, Data & Platform Economies: What Makes African Businesses Investment-Ready in 2026



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11:50-12:10	Executive Fire Chat	Facilitator: Viwe Tini CA(SA)	Finance Executive, Chartered Accountant (Sa), And Advocate For Inclusion And Transformation. Founder and CEO	Sande Capital	The DFI Mandate: Development Capital & Commercial Lending
		Mr Barnabas Masekwameng	ICT Executive	W&RSETA	
		Lebaka Sekgobela	Senior Coverage Banker: Corporate & Investment Banking	ABSA	
12:10-12:55	Executive Panel Discussion	Facilitator: Thuli Magubane	Director	Mint Fresh	The Full Debt Stack: From DFI Facilities to Commercial Loans
		Mokgome Mogoba	Founder & Managing Partner	Kholo Capital	
		Yandiswa Zikalala	Investment Associate	NEF	
		Mr Thulani Guliwe	Senior Research Manager	Gauteng Enterprise Propeller (GEP)	
12:55-13:20	Strategic Masterclass	Lerato Mangope	Founder	Enabling Solutions (Pty) Ltd	Structuring Capital for Growth: How Project Finance, Debt Markets & Infrastructure Finance Unlock Large-Scale African Investment
13:20-14:20	Executive Networking Lunch	Delegates, Funders & Partners			Lunch · Capital Conversations · Investor Networking



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14:20-14:45	Executive Panel Discussion	Facilitator: Sifiso Skenjana	Founder	ESG Now News	Impact Capital, Gender-Lens Mandates & ESG Sectors CEOs Must Watch- Impact Capital & Gender-Lens Investing: Where Smart Money Is Flowing in 2026
		Lane Mogashoa	Senior Manager: Enterprise Development	ABSA	
		Sibongile Zulu	Chairperson of the Board	Capital Unlocked	
		Welleminah Ntombifuthi Mdinisa	Fund Manager	WDB Entrepreneur Fund	
14:45-15:00	Strategic Industry Keynote	Darlene Menzies	CEO	FinFind	The SME Funding Game Changer - Alternative Data and Open Finance
15:00-15:20	Strategic Masterclass	Brian Moyo, CFA	Director of Investments	Strategix Capital Limited	Structuring Capital for African Growth: What Makes Businesses Bankable, Investable & Scalable
15:20-15:45	Executive Panel	Facilitator: Khuthi Mbedzi CA(SA)	Executive Finance Leader		How Corporates Deploy Supply Chain Capital & How SMEs Capture It
		Mr Bongani Ntombela	Executive: Programmes	22 On Sloane	
		Selelo Ramohlola	Head of Strategy & Planning	The Competition Commission South Africa	
		Noluvo Nela	Investment Partner & Fund Head	Edge Growth Ventures	
		Niall Gahan	Head of Enterprisefund	Enterpriseroom	

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15:45-16:10	Industry Strategic Workshop	Dimakatso Mphafudi	Regional Credit Manager : SME	ABSA	ESD Fund Readiness: The Final Checklist Before You Apply
16:10- 16:20	Play your Part	Toni Gumede	Acting Marketing Manager	Brand SA	
16:20- 16:25	Vote of Thanks	Mr Simphiwe Masiza	CEO	Empowaworx	
16:30	Closing Networking Experience	Delegates, Partners & Investors			Closing Networking · Deal Rooms · Partner Activations

CONTINUOUS EXPERIENCE ZONES



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EMPOWAWORX HOUSE
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